

Duolingo English Test (DET) Common Vocabulary Starter Guide

This starter guide contains high-frequency vocabulary commonly useful for the DET Read and Complete (fill in the blanks) task. It is not an official list, but these words appear frequently in academic and everyday contexts.

Common Verbs

accept, achieve, adapt, affect, allow, analyze, appear, apply, arrange, assume, avoid, become, believe, build, change, choose, compare, complete, consider, continue, create, decide, define, describe, develop, discover, discuss, encourage, ensure, establish, evaluate, examine, exist, expect, explain, explore, follow, generate, identify, improve, include, increase, indicate, influence, introduce, learn, maintain, manage, obtain, occur, participate, perform, plan, prepare, prevent, produce, provide, realize, receive, recognize, reduce, require, research, respond, solve, study, suggest, support, understand.

Common Nouns

ability, access, activity, analysis, article, attention, behavior, benefit, business, career, challenge, choice, college, community, company, computer, condition, culture, data, decision, development, education, effect, environment, equipment, example, experience, family, government, growth, health, history, idea, importance, information, internet, knowledge, language, market, method, opportunity, performance, problem, process, product, project, quality, question, relationship, research, resource, result, science, service, society, solution, student, success, support, system, technology, university, value.

Common Adjectives

able, accurate, active, available, basic, careful, central, clear, common, complex, correct, creative, current, different, difficult, effective, efficient, essential, excellent, famous, friendly, general, global, important, interesting, modern, natural, necessary, possible, practical, professional, public, reliable, responsible, serious, similar, simple, special, successful, useful, valuable.

Academic Words

academic, approach, assessment, assumption, concept, conclusion, context, criteria, evidence, factor, feasibility, function, hypothesis, impact, innovation, investigation, objective, observation, outcome, perspective, principle, procedure, significance, strategy, structure, theory, variable.

Transition Words

although, because, besides, however, therefore, moreover, furthermore, instead, meanwhile, otherwise, since, unless, while, whereas, consequently, thus, hence.

Common Endings

-tion, -ment, -ness, -able, -ible, -ous, -ive, -ity, -al, -ly.

Study Tip: Learn 20–30 words each day, review them weekly, and practice them in short sentences. Recognizing prefixes and suffixes helps you solve missing-letter questions faster.